In Game animations:

The animations this time around were way cleaner after the recording due to our lessons on a1. There were still some issues that occurred during the running animations. We noticed one marker missing for the running right animation in the a take and as such swapped it to one of our backup takes. Similarly there was one running animation where the hand starts off upside down but then secured itself for where we would have started editing and as such we kept it as A take.

With this stated, we only needed 25 animations for the assignment and as such decided to exclude the running animations and the death animation due to the extra need for cleaning that might have come up later on. Death was picked because of how it was the hardest to clean previously.

The idle standing animation has a weird head tilt in the middle of its movements, though after later inspection on it and the retakes/security takes, this seems to be the actors movement and not a marker issue.

The light melee animation is swapped from take 0 to take 1 after later discovery that the 0 take had a weird interaction with the actors arm that did not exist in the other takes. 1 was also generally a cleaner take.

The Berserk Mode animation has some shakes on both hands because the actor was hitting a real bag and their hands bounced back. It can be seen looking strange but it's the actors body reacting to recoil and the usage of bags can be debated if it's a smart option or not.

Cinematic animations:

The cinematic is going to be slightly changed due to the knowledge gained with how painful it is to clean animations while the actor is laying down. As such laying down animations will be off screen, having the camera never drop to the ground with the actor. The previous planned death will have the actor instead lay dead on the ground not moving, which we will clean a few frames of to later use as key frames for post animation.

Some shots have been combined into one singular take to have the flow of the scene feel better. The animation list has been updated with new names and descriptions. Each changed shot will be documented here and how it was changed

We had 2 incidents happen during the recording session. First off, our actor that was supposed to play sea king got sick. As such, we had one of our team members step

in as the secondary actor for the cinematic. The camera roll got moved and combined with the director. This was to still have enough assistant on the floor while still having someone operate the camera.

The second incident was that the internal D-drive, at which everything was recorded on, somehow disappeared from the PCs systems mid recording. This was solved with a restart of the whole PC but made us lose the star markers at each recording, leaving us with the need to re-star every A-take.

I believe that a lot of these small changes we have done to scenes stem from us learning more about mocap and its limitations as we kept going. Especially things we learned through the cleaning process of A1 that we did not know to plan around for the pre production until it was too late. If we had this knowledge beforehand then we would have totally changed how we set up the cinematic, new scenes and how we planned for each part of it to play out with these limitations more in mind than we had now.

Confused_Beginning: This is a new scene we added in the beginning of the cinematic as the total time of animation came a bit short from the set goal. This is an introduction, having Erik move around frantically looking for a weapon then ending in the pose that the First_Fight_Prepare starts in.

First_Fight_Prepare:
This animation has the actors start the attack after the camera is arriving at over the shoulder for the sea king, which is at a faster pace and looks better than it was in plan. It ends in a closer shot between the two as they move in to clash.

Get_Up_After_Fight:
With the issues that come to the scenes with an actor laying down, this scene was adjusted to having a side view with the actor sitting up into the shot hiding some of the back as they sit up from the camera view (partly to hide the worst issues that come with a laying down scene). With this angle in mid, the camera wont reach over the actor for when he picks up the weapon. Rather it stays closer to the ground at eye level of the actor while showing the body. This is to steady the camera a bit more as well as it fits more cinematically with the rest of the cinematic.The rest of the scene is played out with the actor walking off, though we combined this with the walking cut in the rehearsal video, having this be the one time the actor walked away.

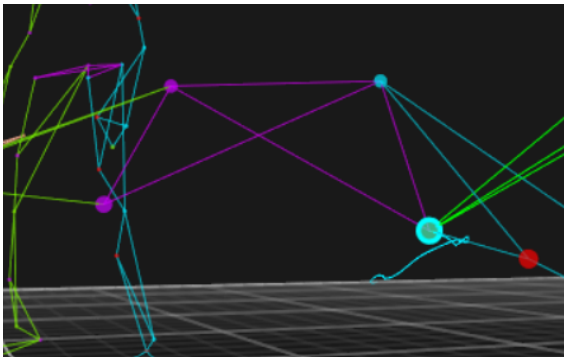
When it came to cleaning this scene I ended up patching and cleaning all of the parts where the actor lays down as well. This is to 1 help with the later animators to better deal with the new camera angles and adjust if needed. As stated above, the shoulderblades seem to go through the ground a bit and as such a camera above

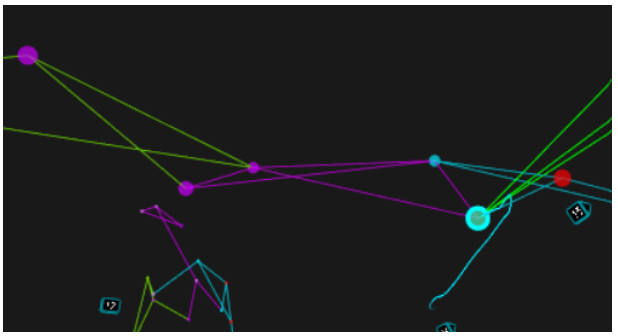
them before the actor sits up would be fitting. This once again makes us realise how painful it is to deal with laying down scenes and if we were to totally redo the whole project, we would not have included any kind of these scenes.

The_Door_Thing:
We add the actor knocking the door before the stranger steps into the view, to help the audience understand what is happening and to have the animators have something to work with when applying a door object in post animations (vibrations with the knock or sound moments). In this clip, the camera is closer to the actors than planned, as well as the stranger is slightly off the middle cause we have a heavy mat on the ground to protect our actors. The actor starts to step too far away from the ground center in the end, resulting in poor data quality. The space limit should be taken into consideration.

In this scene, the victim (Yassine) totally fell out of the camera when got shot from the front, so we left him uncleaned after he did this.

Second_Fight_Start:
There are only 2 issues with this specific take. Firstly, since one of the actors is squatting from the starts, the hips are obscured so there is not a lot of things to work with since the gap is rather long. After I eventually fixed it, it did lead to the hips being slightly misaligned. The way i would fix this in the future is to be more vigilant when recording in order to make sure all the markers are clearly visible, to reduce the occlusion while cleaning.





Secondly, there is slight bone shaking at around frame 530 (Roughly 4 seconds in) which i cannot fix through solving. When i attempted it, it made the skeleton go completely haywire and violently stutter all over the place, i was able to revert it luckily. So i made the brave decision to sacrifice the super minute shaking in order to have the take work.

Second_Fight_Mid:

Small fighting changes happened here from the rehearsal, such as the disarming of the axe, instead of having both actors grip is (4 hands would be hell to clean), we

opted in to have the sea king block the blow then punch Erik's arm, causing him to drop his weapon.

There is a gap for the weapons, but the plan for them is that after they have been knocked out of the hands of the actors, they swap to in-game objects in the engine, adding a small force to them, having them added in the background with no more mocap and fixed with keyframe animation for their falls.

Second_Fight_End:

Some small changes here was the over the head slam on sea king at the end was swapped to an upper cut and spartan kick to prevent Erik to bend forward and risk occlusion. We also combined 2 previous clips here to make the fight have a better flow feel to it, combining the sea kings punches and gloat with Eriks retaliation attacks in one take instead of two as in the rehearsal. The camera kept the similar angle as when the sea king fights with more movement towards the middle of the two.

Both actors are planned to be out of the camera when they are defeated and fall, having the part where they lay on the ground to not be visible and as such will not be cleaned as heavily.

Death_Of_Erik:
This take was changed heavily after we learned how hard it is to clean data with a person crawling and moving while laying down. As such we changed this to the actor laying still while the camera is an over angle above them, first focusing on the body of the actor then slowly going closer and focusing on the axe for the next scene.

While this was easier to clean than if we would have had the actor move around, it was still really painful to clean. The back was totally occluded for a lot of the take and had to be recreated. There are still issues with the shoulder blades going into the ground as well as one of the triceps markers being harder to refill, but with the actor laying still, there is space to later on edit the animation if needed and using the data that still exists.

The left foot bone does have a shake around 700 frames into the take, but this is outside of the camera view and as such left.

If I were to ever do another mocap project then I would avoid any kind of interaction with the ground such as death animations.

Picking_Up_Axe:
Camera swapped a bit more of a side view than a full from the front view to fit more with the rest of the cinematic.

Nothing of note was viewed from this recording to document